# MIND MAP GUIDELINES

In his books on Mind Maps Buzan suggests using the following guidelines for creating them:

- Start in the centre of a blank page turned as landscape. Why because starting in the centre, gives your brain freedom to spread out in all directions and express itself free and naturally.
- Use an image or picture for your central idea. Why? Because an image is worth a 1000 words and helps you use your imagination. A central image is more interesting, keeps you focused, helps you concentrate.
- Use colours throughout, three colours at minimum. Why? Because colours are as exciting to your brain as are images. Colour adds extra vibrancy and life to your mind map, it adds energy to your creative thinking...
- Connect your main branches to the central image and connect your second and third level branches to the first and second levels etc. Why? Because your brain works by associations. It likes to link two, three or four things together. If you connect the branches, you will understand and remember a lot more easily.
- Make your branches curved, rather than straight lined. Why? Because straight lines are boring to your brain.
- Use one key word per line. Why? Because a single word gives your mind map more power and flexibility. Use upper and lower case
- Use images throughout. Why? As each image gives another 1000 words. Each word/image is best alone and sitting on its own line
- The lines should be connected, starting from the central image. The central lines are thicker, organic and thinner as they radiate out from the centre.
- Make the lines the same length as the word/image they support.
- Develop your own personal style of Mind Mapping.

Buzan 1960